



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	20 September 2023	Time of Incident	0900
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number	34014
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Two trucks nearly collide on Great Northern Highway
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Executive Summary

On Wednesday 20 September at approximately 0900, a semi-trailer water truck was travelling at 100km/hr on Great Northern Hwy near Mistake Creek (approx. SLK 2993).

The water truck operator has moved to the edge of the road to allow room for an oncoming road train to pass and has got caught on the edge of the bitumen. The operator has overcorrected trying to stay on the road, resulting in nearly colliding with the oncoming road train.

The operator advised that the overcorrection was caused by the older truck having loose steering. After the incident the semi-trailer water truck was stood down and was assessed by the mechanic.

Incident Photos



Image of water cart

Contributing Factors

- The operator did not identify the hazard and slow down sufficiently as the road train was approaching.
- The operator had not received adequate training on safe driving practices, including maintaining safe distances from oversize vehicles on narrow roads.

Corrective Actions

- Implement Hazard Identification / Communication at pre-start and toolbox meetings, utilising the Site-Specific Risk Register.
- Communicate to all contractors and site Supervisors the hazards on the old section of Great Northern Highway.
- Update the risk register to reflect the hazards of narrow highway sections and soft edges.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- This section of Great Northern Highway has a narrow seal width at 6m, making it difficult for road trains to pass each other without driving on the edge of the rough seal.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads
Critical Risk Profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving**

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations